

03 Price Duration Curve & Spread

48 periods sorted high-to-low · peak/off-peak spread · market structure signal

WHAT TO FIND IMMEDIATELY

Curve steepness	A steep curve (high peak, low trough) = high intraday volatility. A flat curve = stable, well-supplied market. Steepness IS the flexibility opportunity.
Hours above €150	Count the periods above €150, €200. These are the 'scarcity hours' — the economic window for peaking assets and demand response.
Peak/off-peak spread	Peak period (07:00–22:00) avg minus off-peak (22:00–07:00) avg. Track this daily. It is the gross revenue proxy for any cycling asset.
Curve shape	Is the mid-section steep or gradual? Gradual shoulder = well-supplied at mid-prices. Steep = market polarised between very high and very low.

ANGLES — ROTATE ONE PER POST

Spread as BESS signal	Today's spread was €[X]. A 1MW/2MWh battery cycling at optimal times would have earned approx €[Y] gross before efficiency losses.
Scarcity hours count	[N] of 48 periods cleared above €200 today — [up/down] from [M] last week. What drove the change?
Curve vs prior day	Overlay today's PDC against yesterday's. Is the shape similar or has the market structure changed? Why?
Seasonal structure	Summer PDCs tend to be flatter (more wind, less heating demand). Winter PDCs are steeper. Where does today sit on that seasonal curve?
Demand response value	If a large industrial customer curtailed 1MW during the top [N] price periods, what did they save? Quantify it from the PDC.
Arbitrage ceiling	The PDC shows the theoretical maximum arbitrage. Real storage earns less (efficiency, forecast error, charging constraints). What's the realistic fraction?

HOOK SENTENCE FORMULA

Spread angle	"Today's peak/off-peak spread hit €[X]/MWh — [the widest this month / narrower than average] — a [strong/weak] signal for flexibility assets."
Scarcity hours	"Only [N] of 48 periods cleared above €200 today, down from [M] last week. The market is [getting calmer / tightening] as [reason]."
Structure shift	"Today's price duration curve is [steeper/flatter] than last Tuesday's — the same demand profile but [X]% [more/less] wind changed the market structure entirely."

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR SALARY

The PDC is the standard tool used by energy traders, storage developers, and market analysts to assess market structure. Any role at a trading house, consultancy, or storage developer will expect you to speak fluently about spread, scarcity hours, and curve shape. Publishing daily PDC commentary is rare — it signals genuine market analyst capability and is directly relevant to roles at €65k–€100k+.

SALARY SIGNAL KEYWORDS TO USE

Price duration curve	Intraday arbitrage	Scarcity pricing	Market structure	Capture rate
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